

100 GEEKY GIFTS!

Here's a list of 100 breathtaking, badass, and beautiful gifts that any geek would die for. The list is neatly categorised into subsections such as "on the go" etc. The whole expanse includes everything from padlocks to geeky cycles. <http://bit.ly/digit057>

THE SCIENCE OF GREAT MUSIC

Like or hate Rebecca Black?



Scientists are trying to understand and quantify what makes music expressive, and the results are contributing to a greater understanding of how the brain works. <http://nyti.ms/digit056>

MARRYING MICROSOFT NO GOOD FOR NOKIA

Despite Microsoft partnership, Nokia continues to loose ground is what the numbers are saying. It also announced that it intended to cut costs by nearly 20 percent over three years, a move that will most likely eliminate thousands of jobs. <http://nyti.ms/digit058>

LEARN FROM AMAZON'S EC2 OUTAGE

Recently a server outage caused sites like Quora, FourSquare to go offline. While most people are still recovering from the fact that Amazon's usually reliable and highly scalable EC2 platform failed, computing. <http://on.mash.to/digit059>

How to Buy the Best Tablet

Whether you opt for an Apple iPad, a BlackBerry PlayBook, or an Android device, like the Motorola Xoom, purchasing a quality tablet can be a daunting task. Here's what you need to know before you hit the store.



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When the first Apple iPad and the Fusion Garage JooJoo were released within days of each other in early 2010, the world got its first real taste of tablets—and, what some might say, is an excellent summation of the breadth of quality future tablets would offer. At the high end, the iPad, and now the iPad 2, is the benchmark tablet to beat, with top-notch, seamless design paired with a robust app store. The now-discontinued JooJoo was a clunker—it lacked internal storage, often crashed, and basically didn't have any apps, only some basic tools. In between these bookends lies the rest of the tablet field, with early Android tablets (anything running a version lower than Android 3.0) ranking closer to the JooJoo end of the spectrum and newer Android tablets like the Motorola Xoom and upcoming second-generation Samsung Galaxy Tabs taking aim at the iPad. Upon first glance, the upcoming RIM BlackBerry PlayBook also looks to be quite the competitor, with its own operating system and the ability to run some Android apps. So which of the plethora of deceptively similar-looking tablets is worth your sizable investment? Let's look at the key factors you need to consider:

FIRST OFF: DO YOU EVEN NEED A TABLET?

Simply put, tablets aren't really filling any true need right now—they are neither replacements for full-fledged computers nor smartphones. A tablet is a touch-screen media device that is actually most similar to a very advanced portable media player—or an MP3 player with a much larger screen. Yes, many of them have mobile service features, but currently none of them make phone calls via a traditional mobile provider. And while you can get work done on a tablet, you won't get a desktop-grade operating system, like you'll find on a PC.

OPERATING SYSTEM

First, just like with a computer, you must choose your allegiance. Apple's iOS is the mobile platform used by the iPad, as well as the iPhone and iPod touch. By now, you're probably familiar with iOS even if you don't own an iPhone, seeing as the device is as ubiquitous in public as it is in television and movies. On the iPad and the iPad 2, iOS works very similarly to the way it does on the iPhone, with certain tweaks made here and there to take advantage of the tablet's larger 9.7-inch screen. The built-in iPod app on the iPad, for instance, has an extra side menu for additional navigation options that wouldn't fit on a 3.5-inch screen.

- By Tim Gideon



Google's mobile OS, Android, is a different story. There are several iterations of Android, but only one—Android 3.0, a.k.a. Honeycomb—is designed specifically for tablets. Right now, only one tablet offers Honeycomb—the Motorola Xoom—and that makes it the iPad's most viable contender, for now. It is a showcase for Android 3.0, which features an improved, more visual multitasking bar than iOS, as well as superior e-mail notifications. Unfortunately, these two particular strengths, though legitimate, are not strong enough to topple Apple's iOS when you look at the bigger picture. The home-screen for Honeycomb, for example, can get easily cluttered because there are so many different ways to organize, rather than just putting things in tidy folders as you can with iOS. The one you choose will largely depend on your personal preference, so if you can try before you buy, you should.

APPS

Android lacks a strong selection of apps. Even with the newly announced Amazon App Store, the number of Honeycomb